

II ① **Successive**^① governments have permitted such increases on the **grounds**^② that the cost of investing in and running the rail network should be **borne**^③ by those who use it, rather than the general taxpayer. ② Why, the **argument**^④ goes, should a car-driving **pensioner**^⑤ from Lincolnshire have to **subsidise**^⑥ the daily **commute**^⑦ of a **stockbroker**^⑧ from Surrey? ③ **Equally**^⑨, there is a sense that the **travails**^⑩ of commuters in the South East, many of whom will face among the biggest rises, have received too much attention compared to those who must **endure**^⑪ the relatively poor **infrastructure**^⑫ of the Midlands and the North.

历届政府都准许了类似的提价,理由是铁路网的投资与运营成本理应由其使用者而非全体纳税人承担。这种论点认为,林肯郡一位开车出行的领养老金者凭什么要补贴萨里郡一位股票经纪人的日常通勤?此外,历届政府还认为,与中、北部地区不得不忍受相对落后的基础设施的通勤者相比,东南部地区通勤者的出行困境(其中许多人将面临最大的票价涨幅)受到了过多关注。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ① **successive** [sək'sesɪv] *a.* 连续的;相继的
② **ground** [graʊnd] *n.* (常作 grounds) 充分的理由;根据
③ **bear** [beə(r)] *v.* 承受;忍受
④ **argument** ['ɑ:gjumənt] *n.* 论据;理由
⑤ **pensioner** ['penʃənə(r)] *n.* 领养老金(或抚恤金)者
⑥ **subsidise** ['sʌbsɪdaɪz] *v.* (亦作 subsidize) 资助;补助

- ⑦ **commute** [kə'mju:t] *n.* (乘火车等)上下班往返
⑧ **stockbroker** ['stɒkbrəʊkə(r)] *n.* 股票经纪人
⑨ **equally** ['i:kwəli] *ad.* 同样,此外,也
⑩ **travail** ['træveɪl] *n.* 艰难的处境
⑪ **endure** [ɪn'djuə(r)] *v.* 忍耐;忍受
⑫ **infrastructure** ['ɪnfəstrʌktʃə(r)] *n.* 基础设施建设

· 语篇分析 ·

第二、三段分析事件。第二段说明历届政府准许火车票提价的原因。关键词: **Successive governments have permitted such increases.**

①句明确历届政府的“准许”态度,并说明原因一:谁使用,谁付费,铁路成本理应由乘客承担。句子整体以 **Successive governments have... on the grounds that...** (on the grounds that 意为“以……为根据,基于……理由”)聚焦政府行为,体现因果逻辑。主句直接明确历届政府的态度:准许提价(such increases 囊括首段核心信息“火车票价每年必涨”)。从句以取舍结构... should be borne by... rather than... 说明化解铁路成本上涨压力的两种思路,并明确政府的逻辑:“让火车乘客承担铁路成本,提高票价”符合基本经济学原理“谁使用、谁付费”,公平合理;“让所有纳税人承担铁路成本,拿公共税收补贴铁路”则是慷他人之慨,损害纳税人利益。

②句具体展示政府“谁使用,谁买单”这一逻辑。the argument goes(这种观点认为……,这种观点的逻辑是……)表明本句进一步展现政府逻辑。句中选用两个人物,以三重对比(pensioner vs stockbroker, car-driving vs commute, Lincolnshire vs Surrey)凸显政府逻辑(“谁乘车、谁买单”合情合理):一个住在林肯郡(公共交通欠发达地区)、自己开车出行且靠退休金生活的人凭什么要去补贴一个住在萨里郡(公共交通发达地区)、乘火车通勤的股票经纪人/高收入者?

③句进一步说明原因二:谁享受好服务,谁多付费,享受发达的铁路服务就应该承担票价的大幅上涨。Equally, there is a sense that(同样,还有一种意识/观点)表明本句与①②句并列,介绍历届政府的另一层类似逻辑。that 从句以 A have received too much attention compared to B 形成对比:享受东南部地区较发达铁路网的通勤者却因票价涨幅大等(commuters in the South East... the biggest rises)比那些必须忍受中、北部地区较差公共交通设施的通勤者(those who must endure... of the Midlands and the North)受到了太多的关注。政府言外之意:1. 享受好服务,就该多付费,不应受到太多关注;2. 忍受落后设施的地区才更应该受到关注,可考虑通过提高票价改善基础设施。

【深层解读】本段以 **Successive governments have permitted... on the grounds that... the argument goes... there is a sense that...** 介绍历届政府(从纳税人、经济学的角度)准许提价的逻辑:通过提高票价来补贴铁路成本合情合理。这与首段中作者的总体站位(同情通勤者、批判火车运营商)并不矛盾。